Constraint Satisfaction - II

CS5491: Artificial Intelligence

ZHICHAO LU

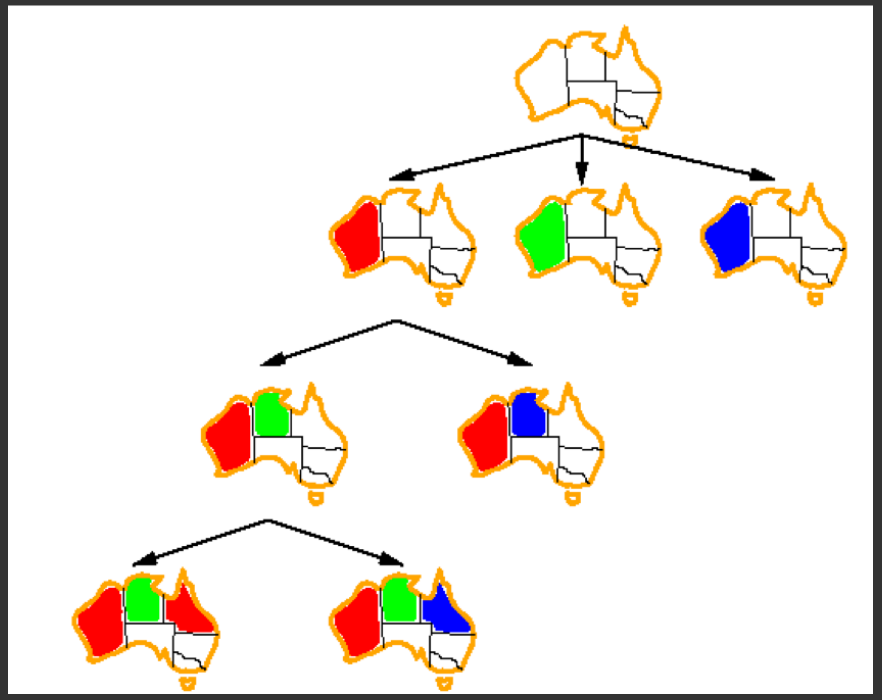
Content Credits: Prof. Wei's CS4486 Course
and Prof. Boddeti's AI Course

TODAY

Backtracking Search

Improvements to Backtracking Search:

- Ordering
- Filtering
- Problem Structure



Backtracking search on the map

Reading

- Today's Lecture: RN Chapter 6
- Next Lecture: RN Chapter 5.1-5.3

BACKTRACKING SEARCH



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Backtracking search is the basic uninformed algorithm for solving CSPs



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  - Problem is commutative if order of application of any given set of actions has no effect on outcome.
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DFS with these two improvements is called backtracking search (not the best name)

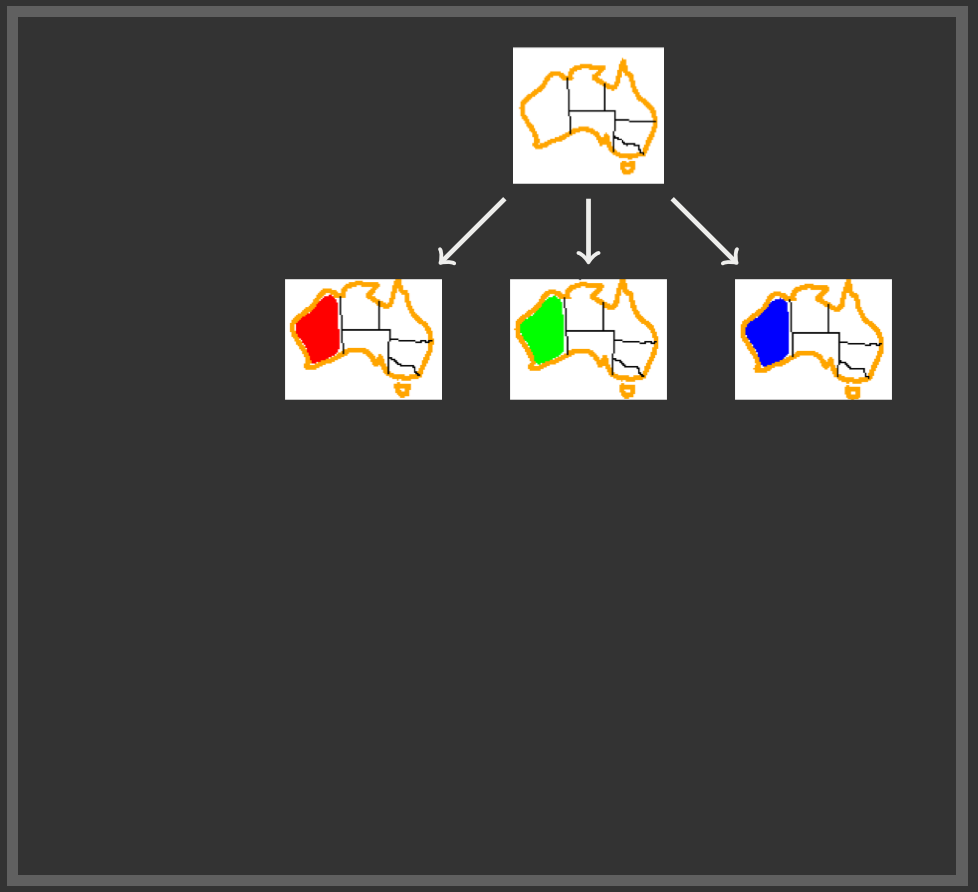
Can solve n-queens for $n \approx 25$



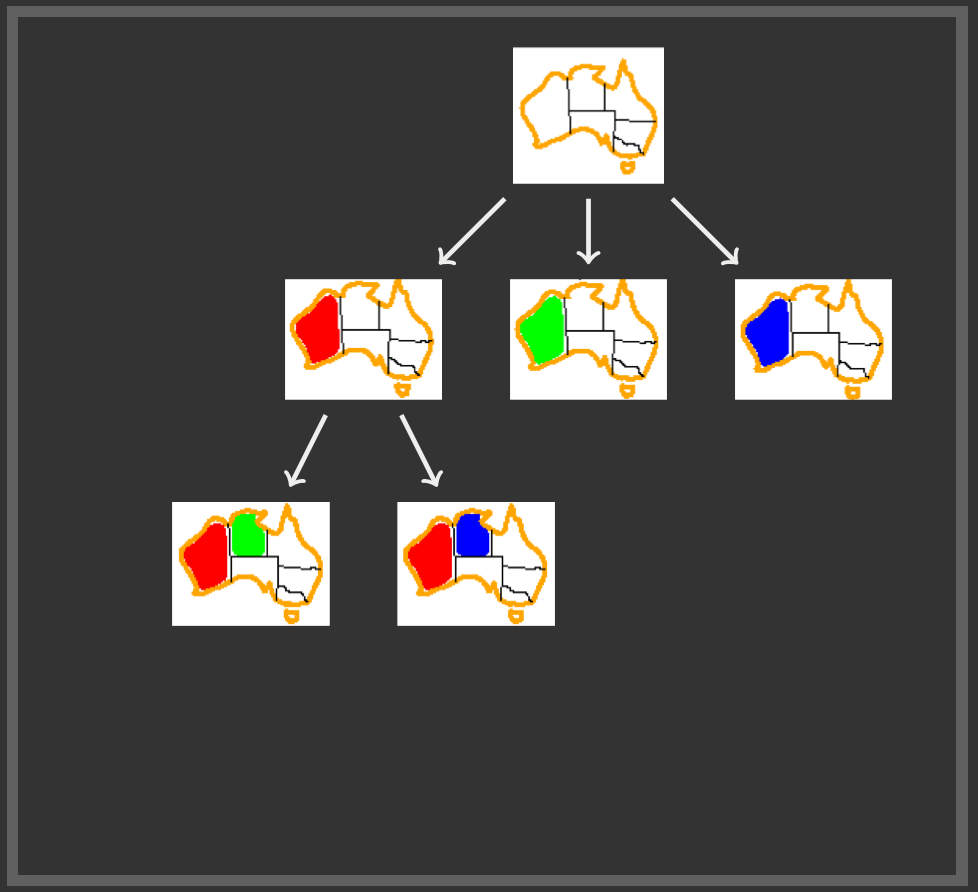
BACKTRACKING EXAMPLE



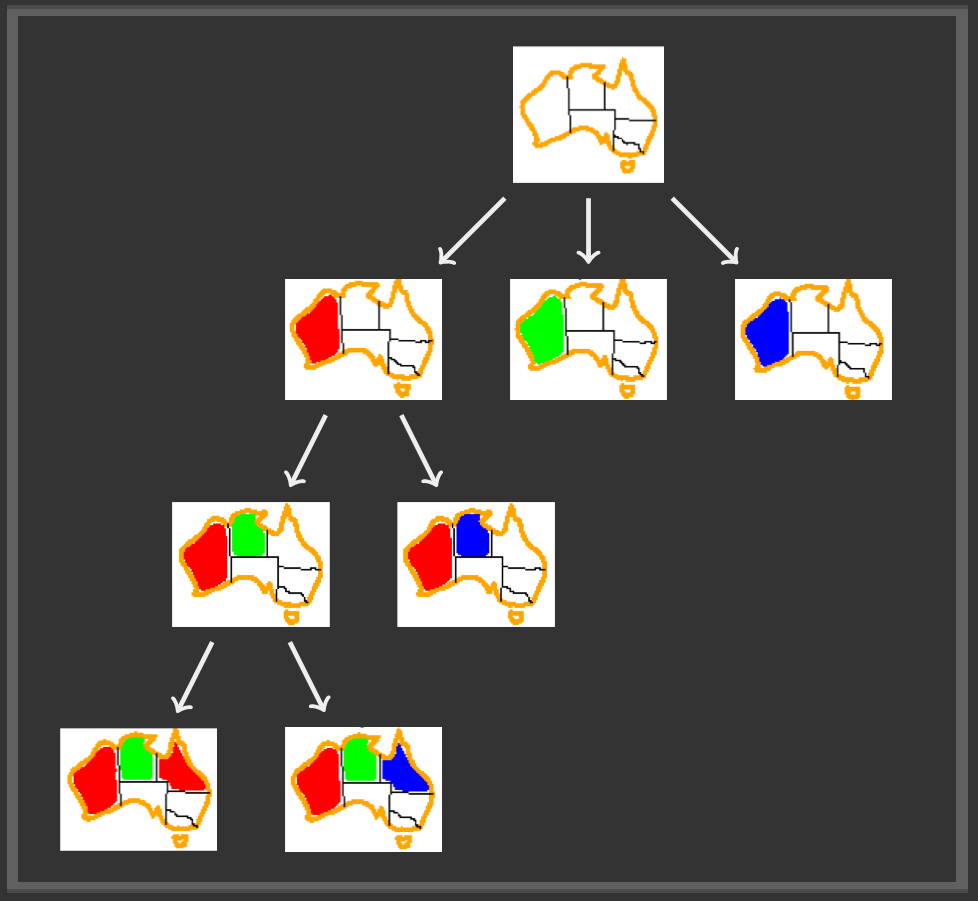
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BACKTRACKING SEARCH

```
function BACKTRACKING-SEARCH(csp) returns solution/failure
    return RECURSIVE-BACKTRACKING({ }, csp)

function RECURSIVE-BACKTRACKING(assignment, csp) returns soln/failure
    if assignment is complete then return assignment
    var ← SELECT-UNASSIGNED-VARIABLE(VARIABLES[csp], assignment, csp)
    for each value in ORDER-DOMAIN-VALUES(var, assignment, csp) do
        if value is consistent with assignment given CONSTRAINTS[csp] then
            add {var = value} to assignment
            result ← RECURSIVE-BACKTRACKING(assignment, csp)
            if result ≠ failure then return result
            remove {var = value} from assignment
    return failure
```

Backtracking = DFS + variable-ordering + fail-on-violation

IMPROVING BACKTRACKING SEARCH



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General-purpose ideas give huge gains in speed

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ORDERING



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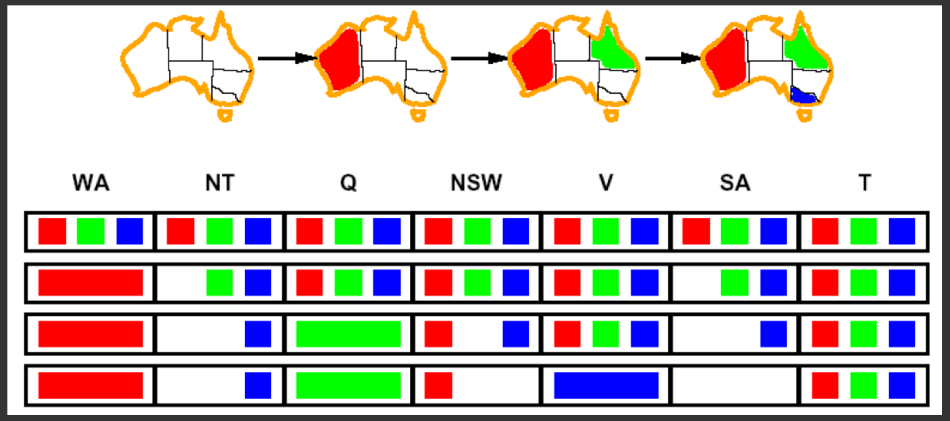
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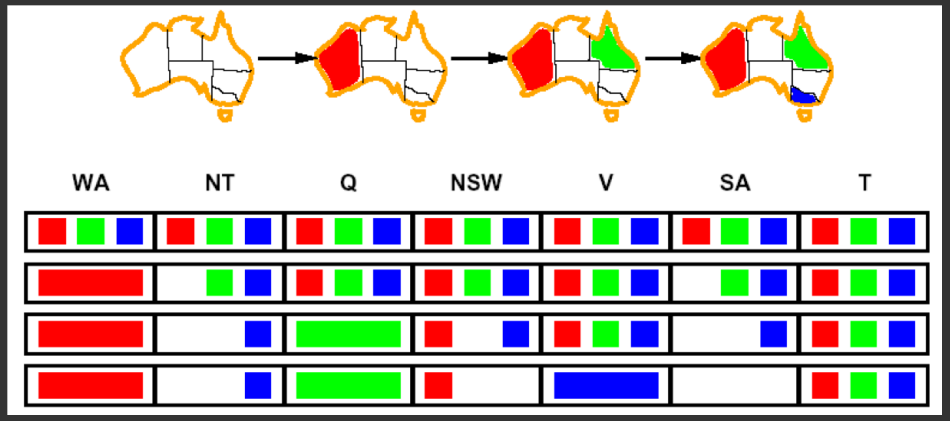
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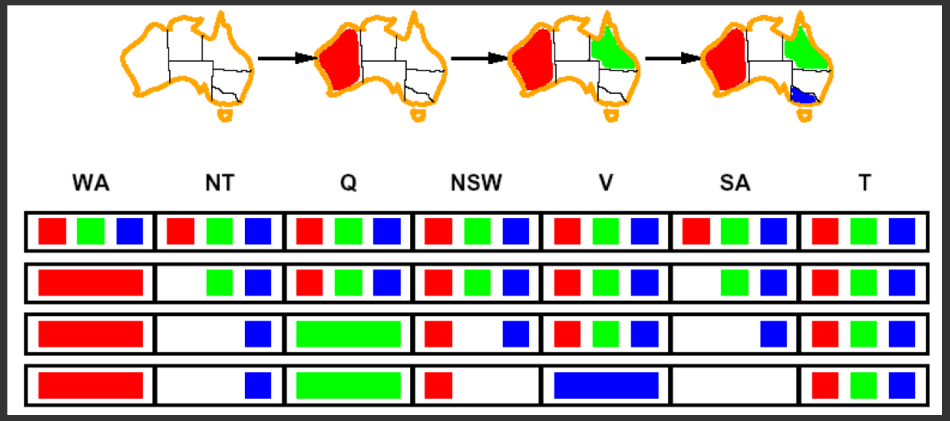


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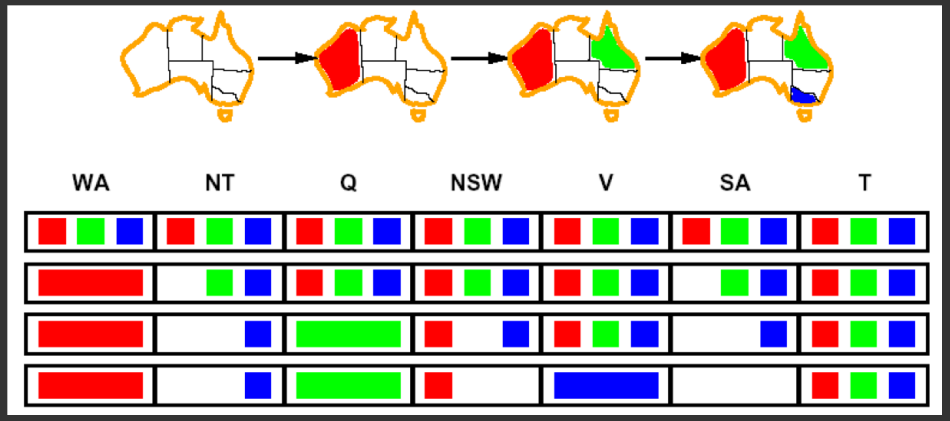
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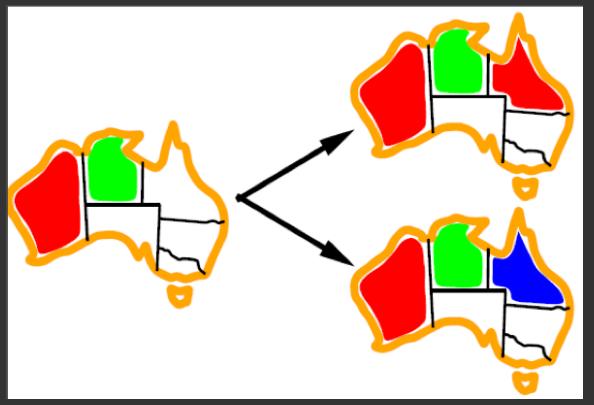


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"Fail-fast" ordering

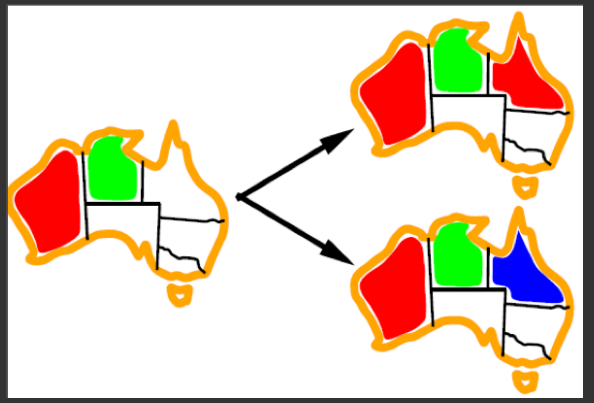
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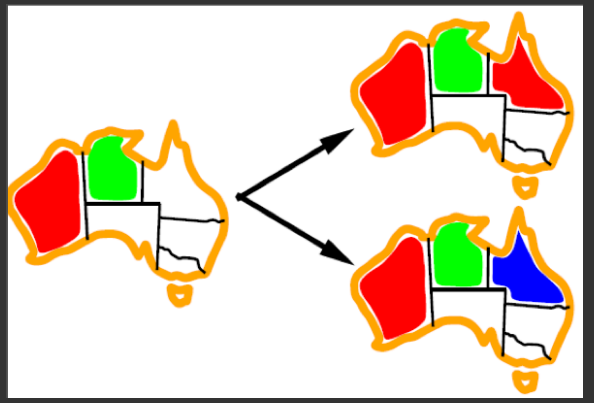
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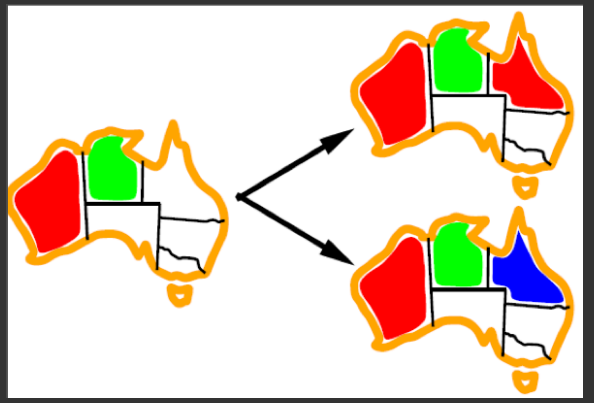
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Why least rather than most?

Combining these ordering ideas makes 1000 queens feasible

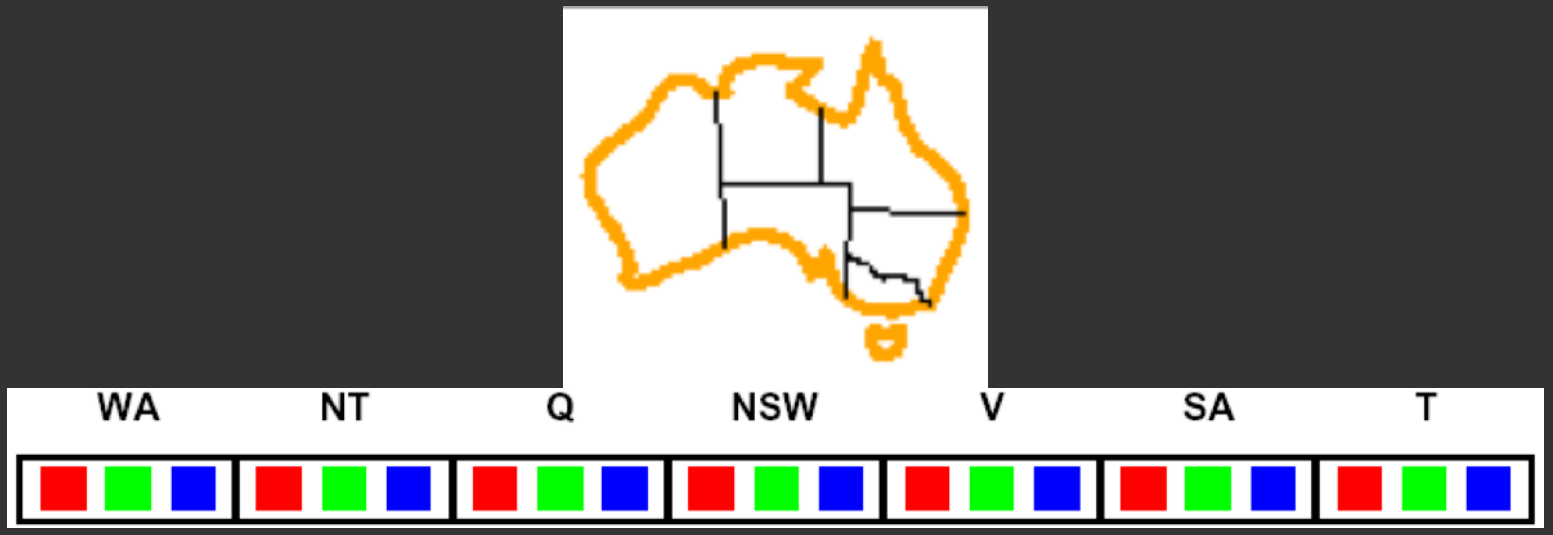
FILTERING



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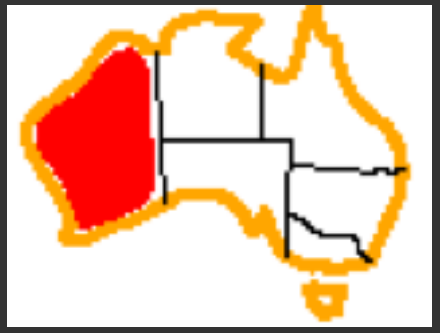
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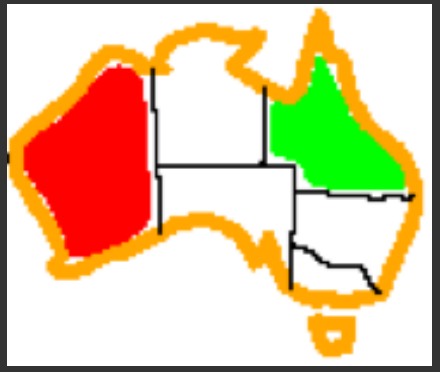




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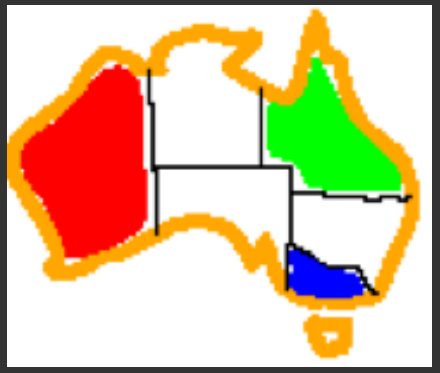




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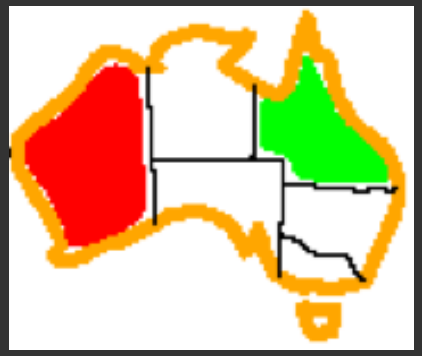
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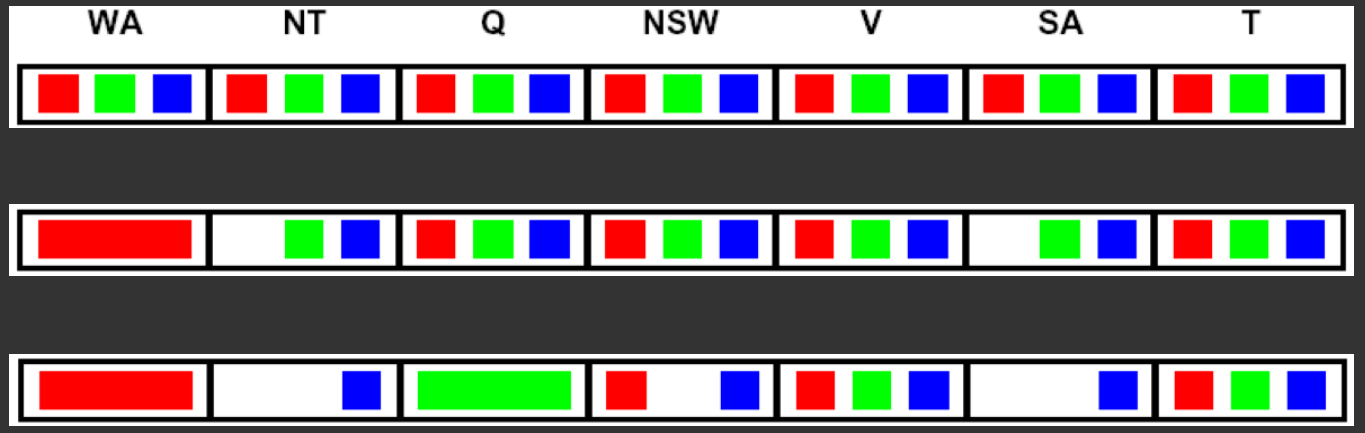




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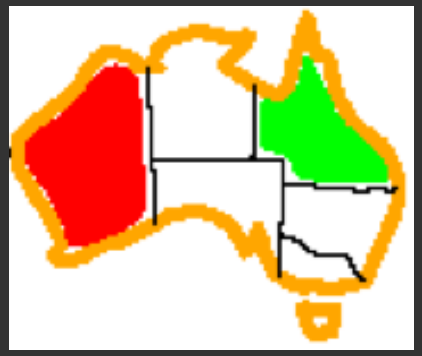
Forward checking propagates information from assigned to unassigned variables, but doesn't provide early detection for all failures:

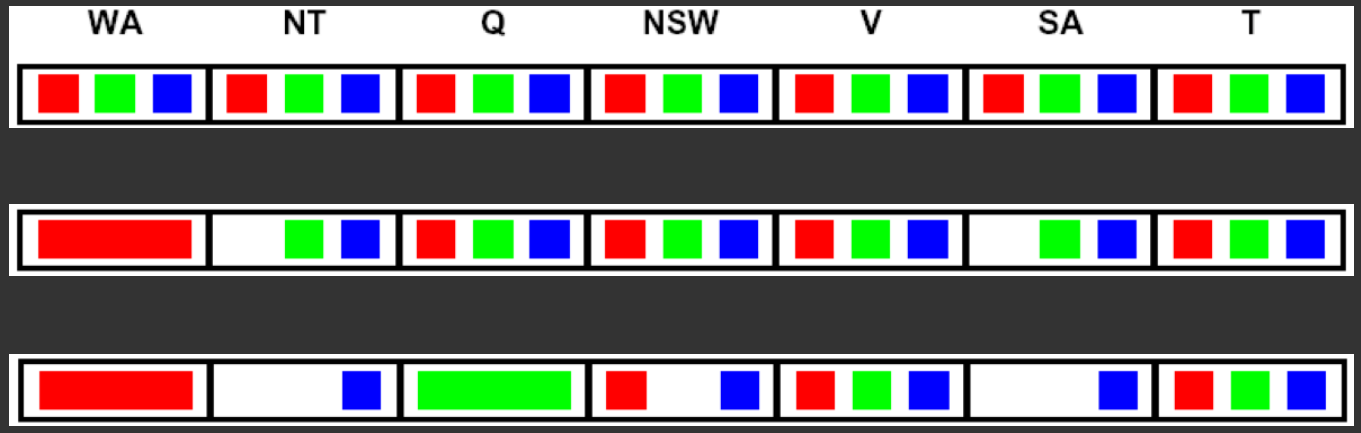




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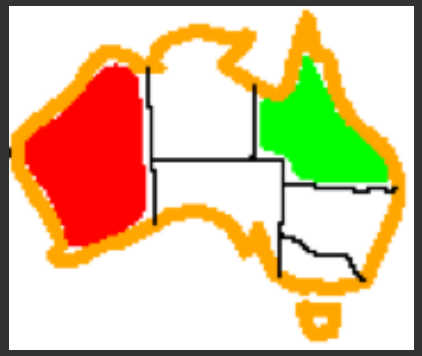


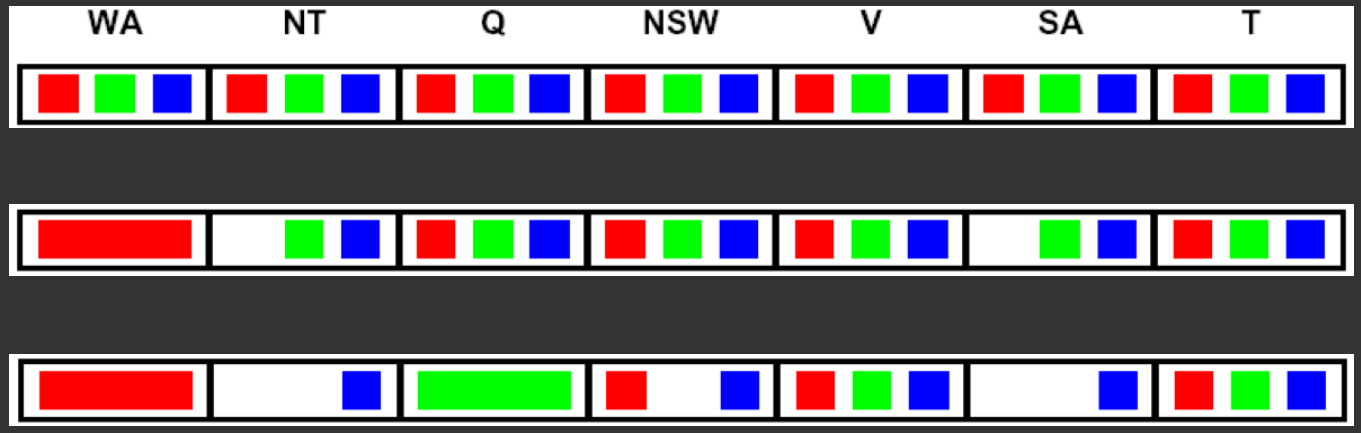


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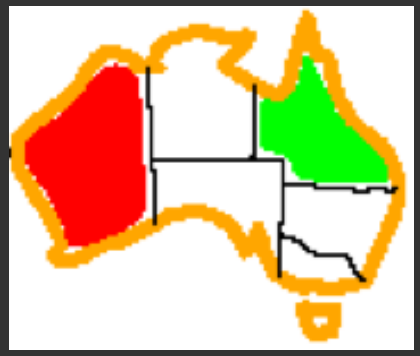


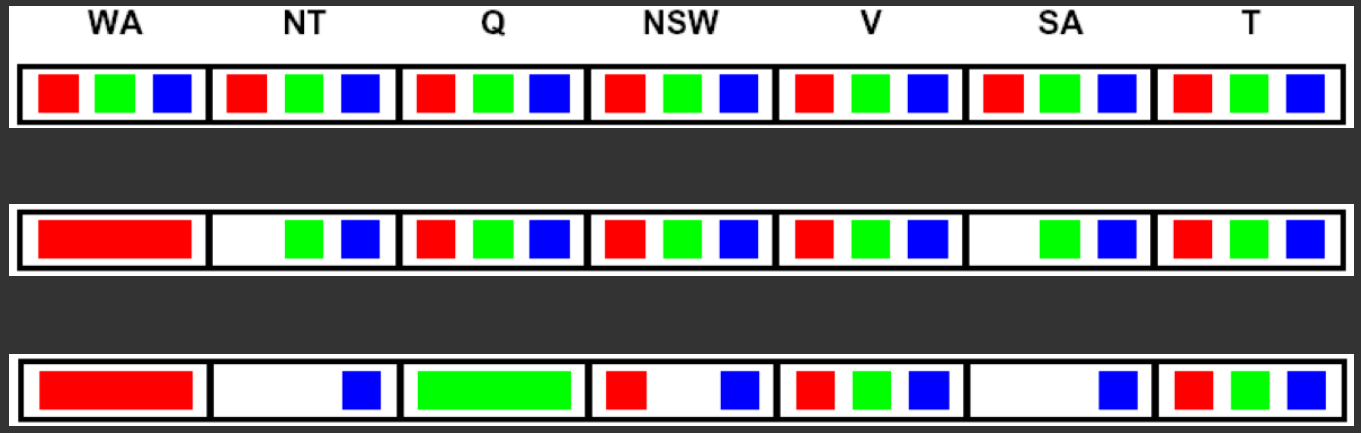
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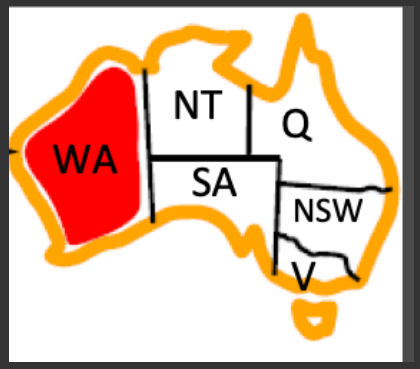
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Constraint propagation: reason from constraint to constraint

CONSISTENCY OF A SINGLE ARC

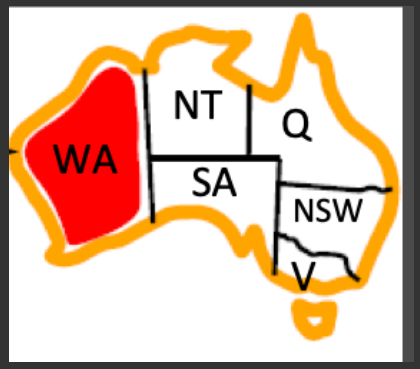
An arc $X \rightarrow Y$ is consistent iff for *every* x in the tail there is some y in the head which could be assigned without violating a constraint.

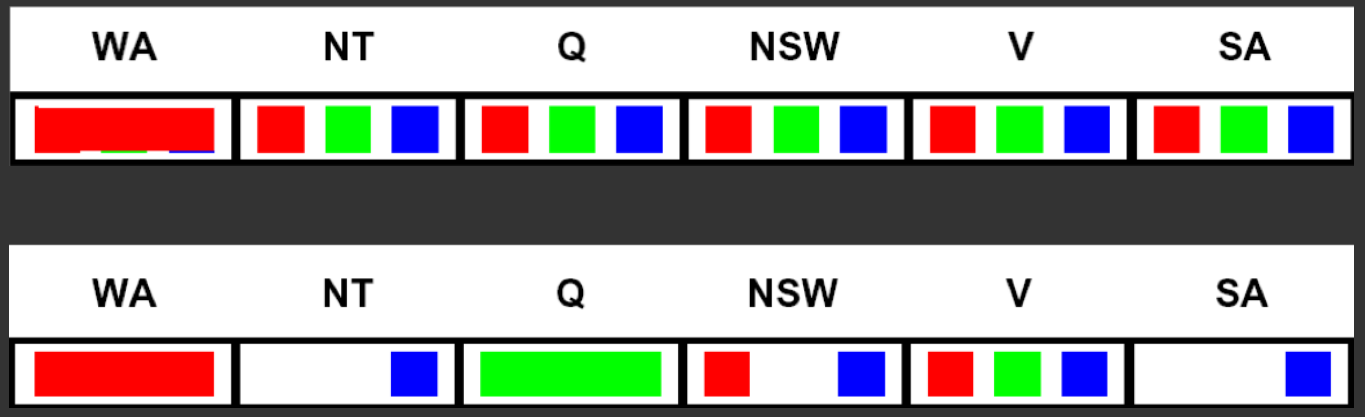




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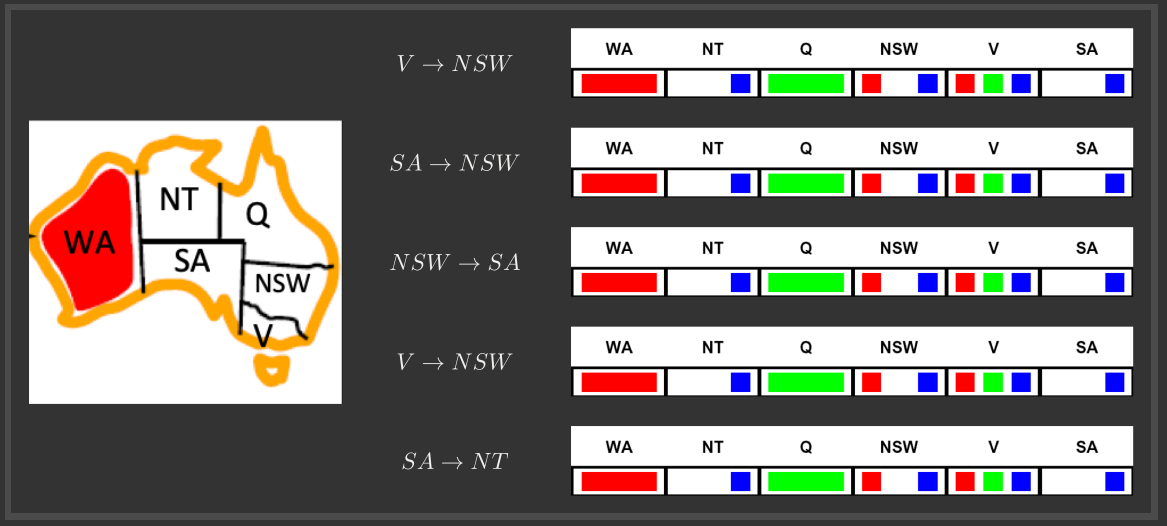


Forward checking: Enforcing consistency of arcs pointing to each new assignment.

Delete from the tail !!

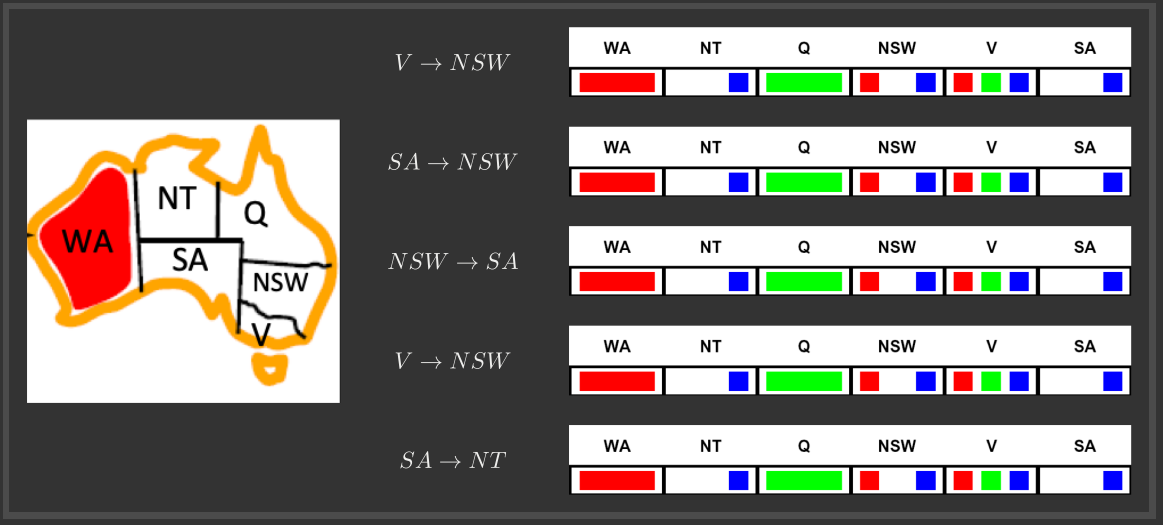
ARC CONSISTENCY OF AN ENTIRE CSP

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Important: If X loses a value, neighbors of X need to be rechecked.

Arc consistency detects failure earlier than forward checking

Can be run as a preprocessor or after each assignment

What is the downside of enforcing arc consistency?

ENFORCING ARC CONSISTENCY IN A CSP: AC

```
function AC-3( csp) returns the CSP, possibly with reduced domains
  inputs: csp, a binary CSP with variables {X_1, X_2, ..., X_n}
  local variables: queue, a queue of arcs, initially all the arcs in csp

  while queue is not empty do
    (X_i, X_j) ← REMOVE-FIRST(queue)
    if REMOVE-INCONSISTENT-VALUES(X_i, X_j) then
      for each X_k in NEIGHBORS[X_i] do
        add (X_k, X_i) to queue

---------------------------------------------------------------------

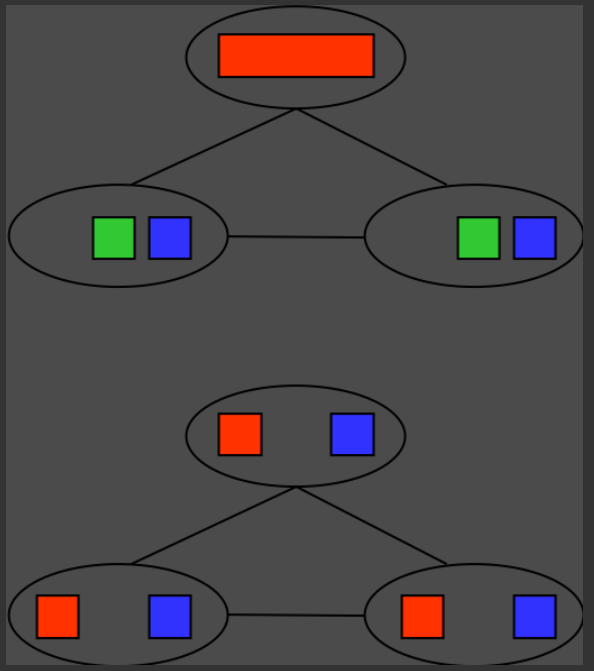
function REMOVE-INCONSISTENT-VALUES( X_i, X_j) returns true iff succeeds
  removed ← false
  for each x in DOMAIN[X_i] do
    if no value y in DOMAIN[X_j] allows (x,y) to satisfy the constraint X_i ↔ X_j
      then delete x from DOMAIN[X_i]; removed ← true
  return removed
```

Runtime: $\mathcal{O}(n^2 d^3)$, can be reduced to $\mathcal{O}(n^2 d^2)$

But detecting all possible future problems is NP-hard.

LIMITATIONS OF ARC CONSISTENCY

After enforcing arc consistency:

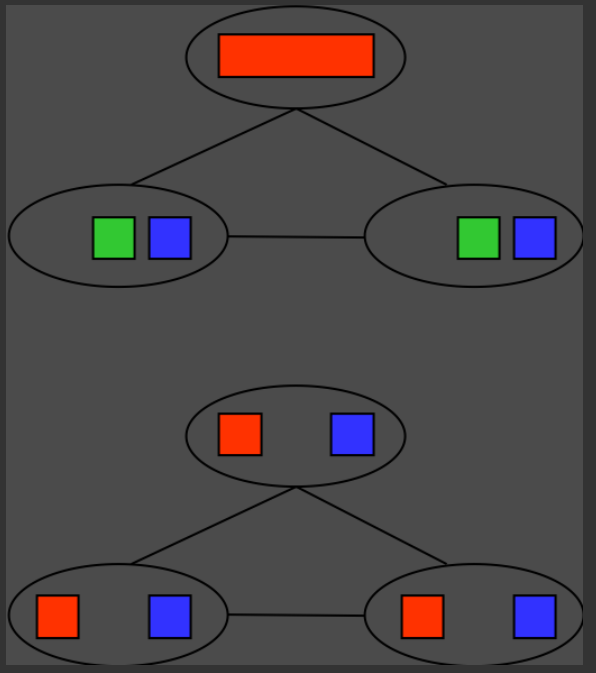


Top: arc consistent, solutions exist. Bottom: arc consistent, no solution.

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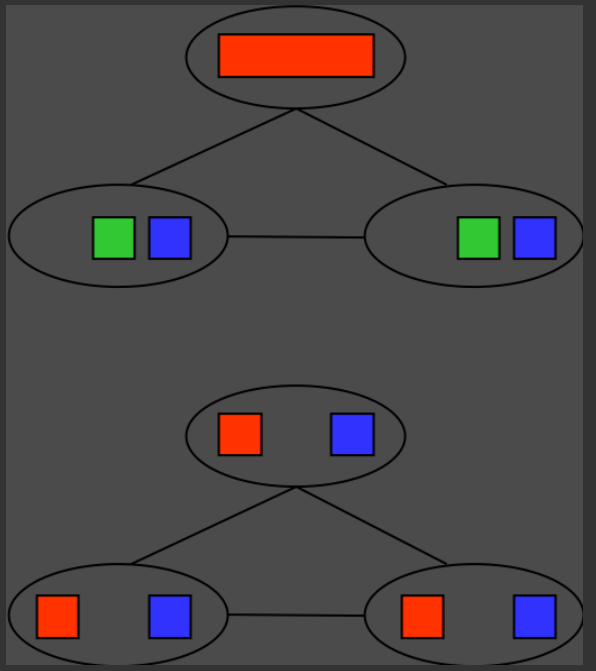
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Arc consistency still runs inside a backtracking search.



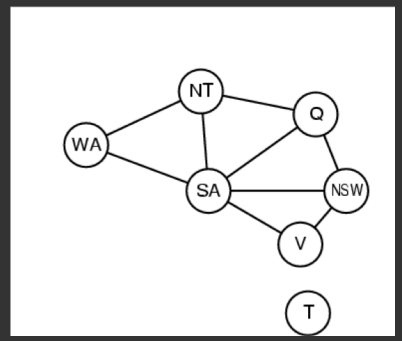
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PROBLEM STRUCTURE

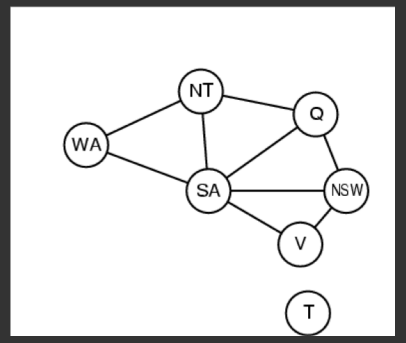


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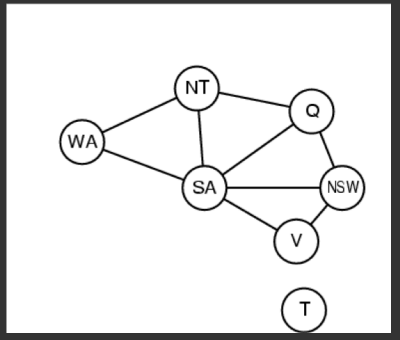
Real world problem can be decomposed into many subproblems.



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Extreme case: independent subproblems

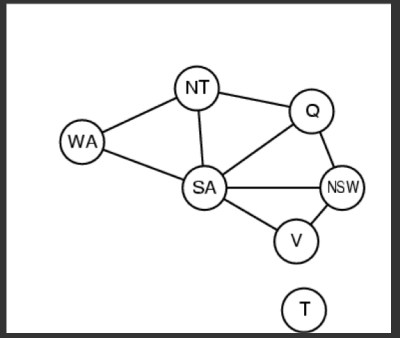


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- Tasmania and mainland are independent subproblems



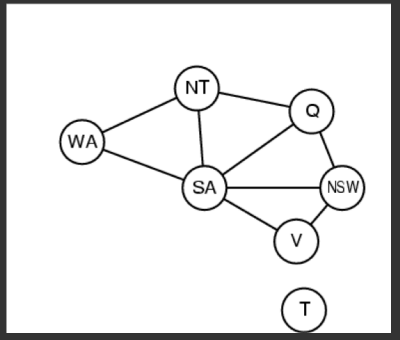
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Independent subproblems are identifiable as connected components of constraint graph



PROBLEM STRUCTURE

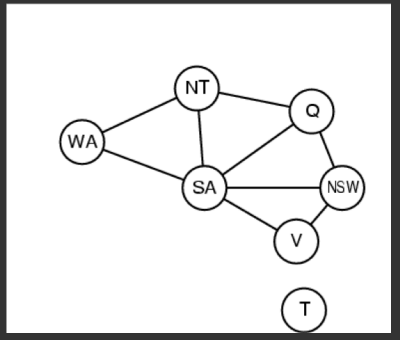
Real world problem can be decomposed into many subproblems.

Extreme case: independent subproblems

- Tasmania and mainland are independent subproblems

Independent subproblems are identifiable as connected components of constraint graph

Suppose a graph of n variables can be broken into subproblems of only c variables:



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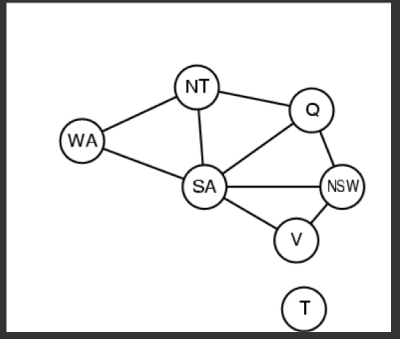
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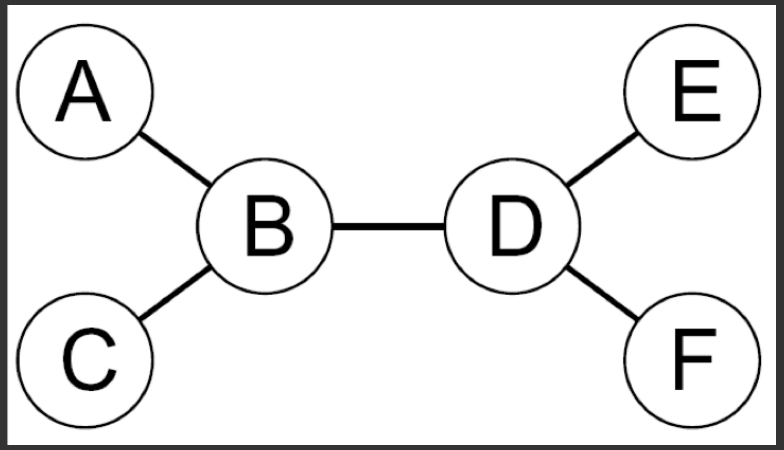
Independent subproblems are identifiable as connected components of constraint graph

Suppose a graph of n variables can be broken into subproblems of only c variables:

- Worst-case solution cost is $\mathcal{O}((n/c)(d^c))$, linear in n
- E.g., $n = 80, d = 2, c = 20$
- $2^{80} = 4$ billion years at 10 million nodes/sec
- $(4)(2^{20}) = 0.4$ seconds at 10 million nodes/sec



PROBLEM STRUCTURE



Theorem: if the constraint graph has no loops, the CSP can be solved in $\mathcal{O}(nd^2)$ time

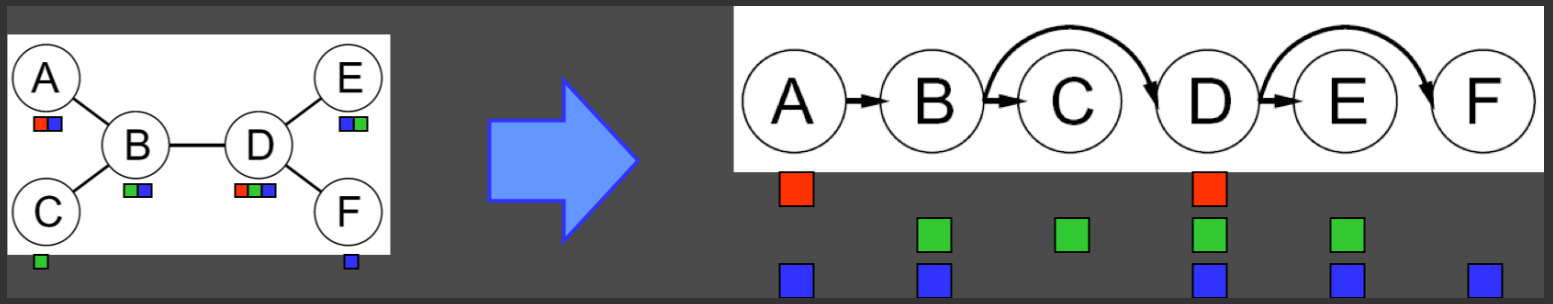
- Compare to general CSPs, where worst-case time is $\mathcal{O}(d^n)$

This property also applies to probabilistic reasoning (later): an example of the relation between syntactic restrictions and the complexity of reasoning.

PROBLEM STRUCTURE

Algorithm for tree-structured CSPs:

- Order: Choose a root variable, order variables so that parents precede children

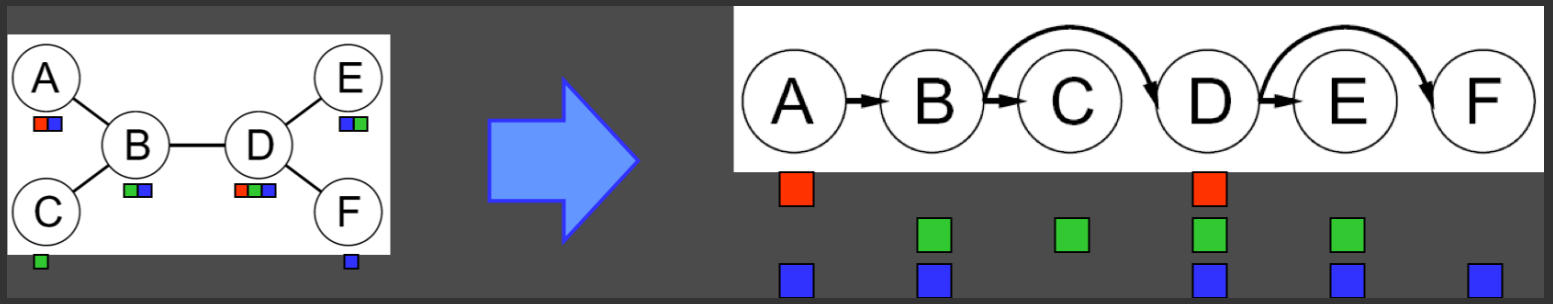


- Remove backward: For $i = n$ down to 2, apply RemoveInconsistent(Parent(X_i),X_i)
- Assign forward: For $i = 1$ to n, assign X_i consistently with Parent(X_i)

PROBLEM STRUCTURE

Algorithm for tree-structured CSPs:

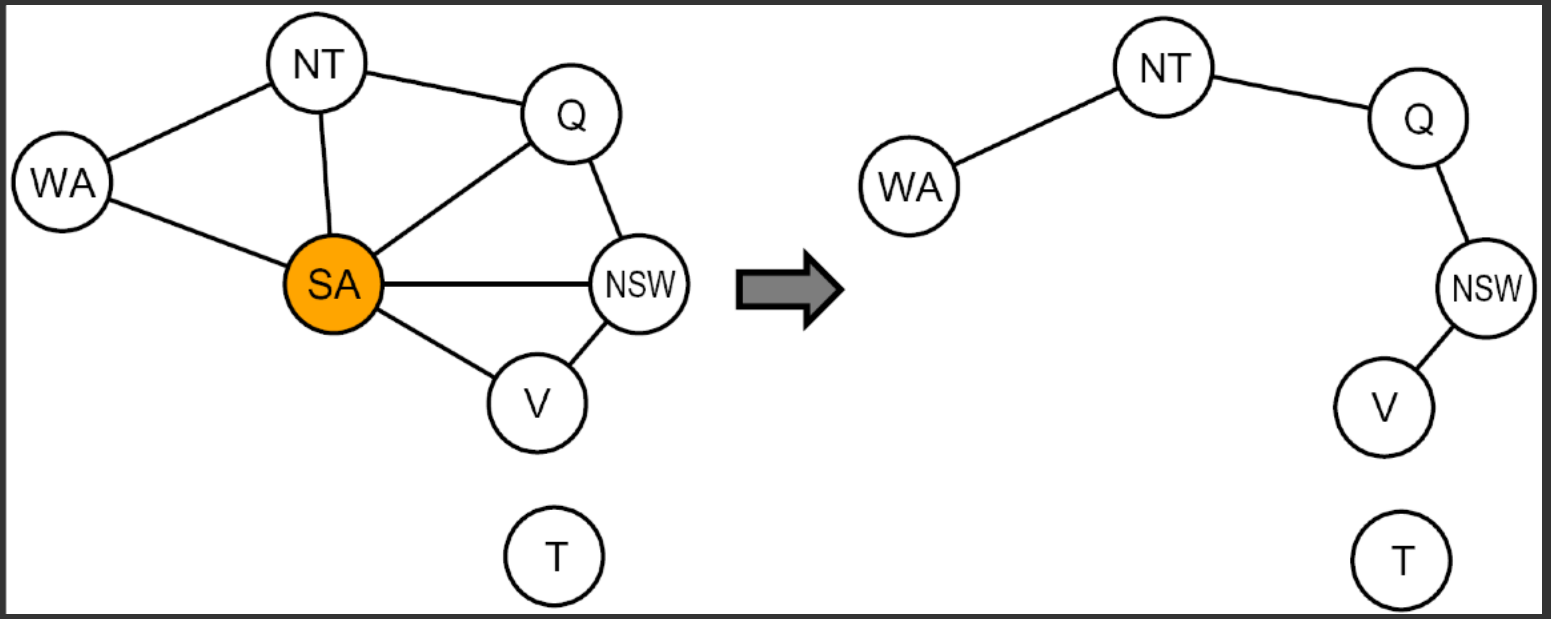
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Runtime: $\mathcal{O}(nd^2)$

PROBLEM STRUCTURE

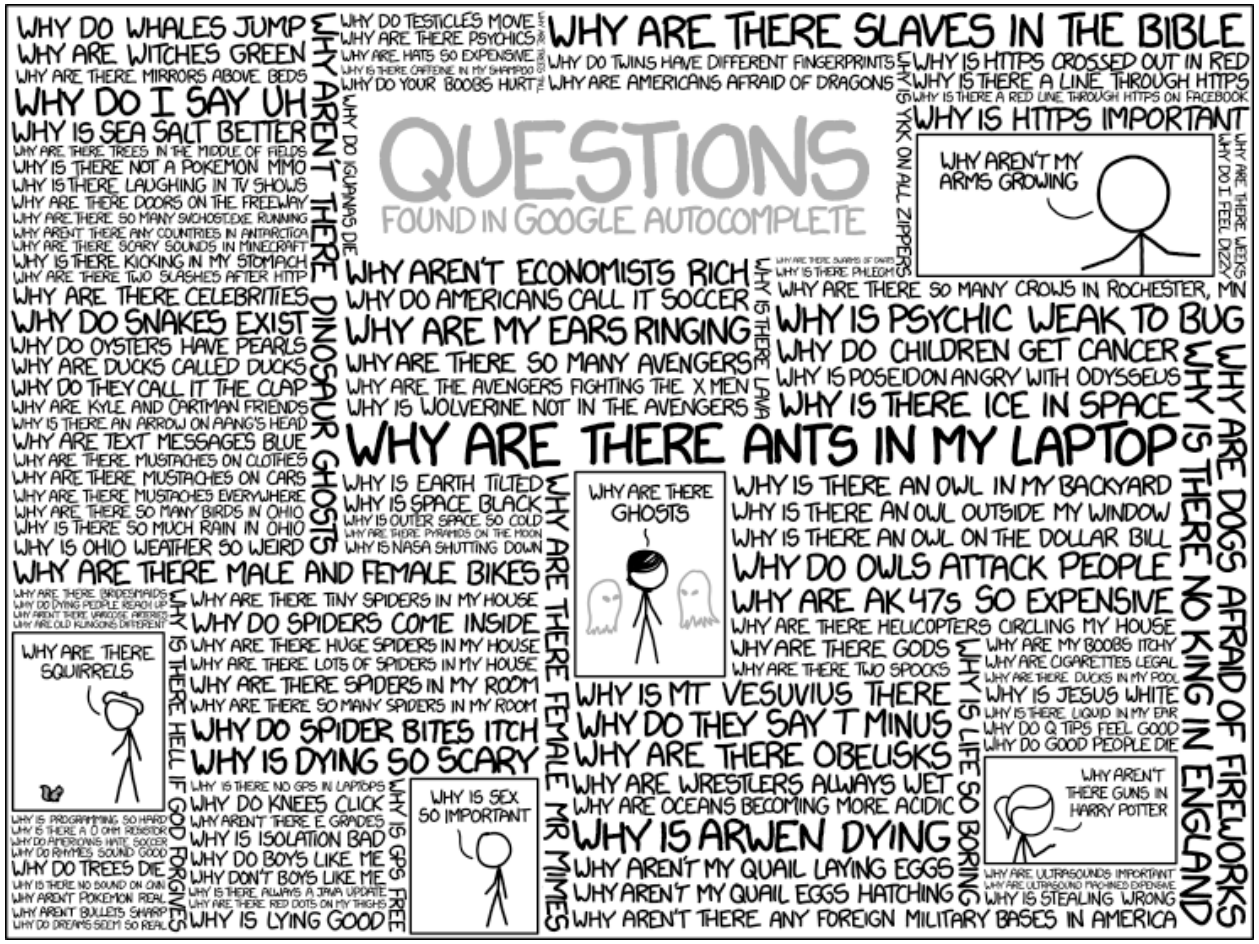


Conditioning: instantiate a variable, prune its neighbors' domains

Cutset conditioning: instantiate (in all ways) a set of variables such that the remaining constraint graph is a tree

Cutset size c gives runtime $\mathcal{O}((d^c)(n-c)d^2)$, very fast for small c.

Q & A


QUESTIONS
FOUND IN GOOGLE AUTOCOMPLETE
WHY ARE THERE SLAVES IN THE BIBLE
WHY DO WHALES JUMP
WHY ARE WITCHES GREEN
WHY ARE THERE MIRRORS ABOVE BEDS
WHY DO I SAY UH
WHY IS SEA SALT BETTER
WHY ARE THERE TREES IN THE MIDDLE OF FIELDS
WHY IS THERE NOT A POKEMON MMO
WHY IS THERE LAUGHING IN TV SHOWS
WHY ARE THERE DOORS ON THE FREEWAY
WHY ARE THERE SO MANY SWCHOSTJDXE RUNNING
WHY ARENT THERE ANY COUNTRIES IN ANTARCTICA
WHY ARE THERE SCARY SOUNDS IN MINECRAFT
WHY IS THERE KICKING IN MY STOMACH
WHY ARE THERE TWO SLASHES AFTER HTTP
WHY ARE THERE CELEBRITIES
WHY DO SNAKES EXIST
WHY DO OYSTERS HAVE PEARLS
WHY ARE DUCKS CALLED DUCKS
WHY DO THEY CALL IT THE CLAP
WHY ARE KYLE AND CARTMAN FRIENDS
WHY IS THERE AN ARROW ON AANG'S HEAD
WHY ARE TEXT MESSAGES BLUE
WHY ARE THERE MUSTACHES ON CLOTHES
WHY ARE THERE MUSTACHES ON CARS
WHY ARE THERE MUSTACHES EVERYWHERE
WHY ARE THERE SO MANY BIRDS IN OHIO
WHY IS THERE SO MUCH RAIN IN OHIO
WHY IS OHIO WEATHER SO WEIRD
WHY ARE THERE MALE AND FEMALE BIKES
WHY ARE THERE BRIDESMAIDS
WHY DO DYING PEOPLE REACH UP
WHY AREN'T THERE VARICOSE AFFERETS
WHY ARE OLD KLINGONS DIFFERENT
WHY ARE THERE SQUIRRELS
WHY IS PROGRAMMING SO HARD
WHY IS THERE A 0 OHM RESISTOR
WHY DO AMERICANS HATE SOCCER
WHY DO RHYMES SOUND GOOD
WHY DO TREES DIE
WHY IS THERE NO SOUND ON OVA
WHY AREN'T POKEMON REAL
WHY AREN'T BULLETS SHARP
WHY DO DREAMS SEEM SO REAL
WHY ARE THERE TINY SPIDERS IN MY HOUSE
WHY DO SPIDERS COME INSIDE
WHY ARE THERE HUGE SPIDERS IN MY HOUSE
WHY ARE THERE LOTS OF SPIDERS IN MY HOUSE
WHY ARE THERE SPIDERS IN MY ROOM
WHY ARE THERE SO MANY SPIDERS IN MY ROOM
WHY DO SPIDER BITES ITCH
WHY IS DYING SO SCARY
WHY IS THERE NO GPS IN LAPTOPS
WHY DO KNEES CLICK
WHY AREN'T THERE E GRADES
WHY IS ISOLATION BAD
WHY DO BOYS LIKE ME
WHY DON'T BOYS LIKE ME
WHY IS THERE ALWAYS A JAVA UPDATE
WHY ARE THERE RED DOTS ON MY THIGHS
WHY IS LYING GOOD
WHY DO TESTICLES MOVE
WHY ARE THERE PSYCHICS
WHY ARE HATS SO EXPENSIVE
WHY IS THERE CAFFEINE IN MY SHAMPOO
WHY DO YOUR BOOBS HURT
WHY DO TWINS HAVE DIFFERENT FINGERPRINTS
WHY ARE AMERICANS AFRAID OF DRAGONS
WHY IS HTTPS CROSSED OUT IN RED
WHY IS THERE A LINE THROUGH HTTPS
WHY IS THERE A RED LINE THROUGH HTTPS ON FACEBOOK
WHY IS HTTPS IMPORTANT
WHY AREN'T MY ARMS GROWING
WHY ARE THERE SWANS AT DAWN
WHY IS THERE PHLEGM
WHY ARE THERE SO MANY CROWS IN ROCHESTER, MN
WHY AREN'T ECONOMISTS RICH
WHY DO AMERICANS CALL IT SOCCER
WHY ARE MY EARS RINGING
WHY ARE THERE SO MANY AVENGERS
WHY ARE THE AVENGERS FIGHTING THE X MEN
WHY IS WOLVERINE NOT IN THE AVENGERS
WHY IS PSYCHIC WEAK TO BUG
WHY DO CHILDREN GET CANCER
WHY IS POSEIDON ANGRY WITH ODYSSEUS
WHY IS THERE ICE IN SPACE
WHY ARE THERE ANTS IN MY LAPTOP
WHY IS EARTH TILTED
WHY IS SPACE BLACK
WHY IS OUTER SPACE SO COLD
WHY ARE THERE PYRAMIDS ON THE MOON
WHY IS NASA SHUTTING DOWN
WHY ARE THERE GHOSTS
WHY IS THERE AN OWL IN MY BACKYARD
WHY IS THERE AN OWL OUTSIDE MY WINDOW
WHY IS THERE AN OWL ON THE DOLLAR BILL
WHY DO OWLS ATTACK PEOPLE
WHY ARE AK 47s SO EXPENSIVE
WHY ARE THERE HELICOPTERS CIRCLING MY HOUSE
WHY ARE THERE GODS
WHY ARE THERE TWO SPOOKS
WHY IS MT VESUVIUS THERE
WHY DO THEY SAY T MINUS
WHY ARE THERE OBELISKS
WHY ARE WRESTLERS ALWAYS WET
WHY ARE OCEANS BECOMING MORE ACIDIC
WHY IS ARWEN DYING
WHY AREN'T MY QUAIL LAYING EGGS
WHY AREN'T MY QUAIL EGGS HATCHING
WHY AREN'T THERE ANY FOREIGN MILITARY BASES IN AMERICA
WHY ARE MY BOOBS ITCHY
WHY ARE CIGARETTES LEGAL
WHY ARE THERE DUCKS IN MY POOL
WHY IS JESUS WHITE
WHY IS THERE LIQUID IN MY EAR
WHY DO Q TIPS FEEL GOOD
WHY DO GOOD PEOPLE DIE
WHY AREN'T THERE GUNS IN HARRY POTTER
WHY ARE ULTRASOUNDS IMPORTANT
WHY ARE ULTRASOUND MACHINES EXPENSIVE
WHY IS STEALING WRONG
WHY IS SEX SO IMPORTANT
WHY ARE THERE FEMALE MR MIMES
WHY IS THERE HELL IF GOD FORGIVES
WHY IS GPS FREE
WHY IS LIFE SO BORING
WHY ARE THERE DINOSAUR GHOSTS
WHY AREN'T THERE
WHY DO IGUANAS DIE
WHY IS YKK ON ALL ZIPPERS
WHY ARE DOGS AFRAID OF FIREWORKS
WHY IS THERE NO KING IN ENGLAND
WHY ARE THERE WEEKS
WHY DO I FEEL DIZZY

XKCD